

There are no type declarations, and the types of variables can change (remember, this is dynamic typing). Also, the addition operator works differently in the two examples because of type coercion (this is known as weak typing). *Don't rely on types in CoffeeScript.*

Existential operator

The existential operator is provided by `?`. You use it to evaluate whether something is defined *and* has a value other than `null` assigned to it:

```
pegasus?
# false
roundSquare?
# false
pegasus = 'Horse with wings'
pegasus?
# true
```

When something hasn't been defined, it has the *undefined* type:

```
typeof roundSquare
# 'undefined'
```

But *undefined* has an uncomfortable place in JavaScript, and type checks should generally be avoided. Here's a common phrase from JavaScript:

```
typeof pegasus !== "undefined" and pegasus !== null
#false
```

With the existential operator, you have a simpler way to express the same thing:

```
pegasus?
# false
```